

# mtg-liquidity-signal: the Current Liquidity index

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**Snapshot 2026-07-30. By Cameraderie Cards. Informational only, not financial advice.**

Every existing model in this toolkit tells you *direction*: will a card rise (buy), has it peaked (sell), is it about to be reprinted (brace). None of them tells you whether you can actually **exit**. A perfect sell call is worthless on a card that takes months to move and only at a deep discount. This model fills that gap. It assigns every Magic: The Gathering card a **Current Liquidity** score from 0 to 100: how easily an owner could turn it into cash right now.

## What goes into the score

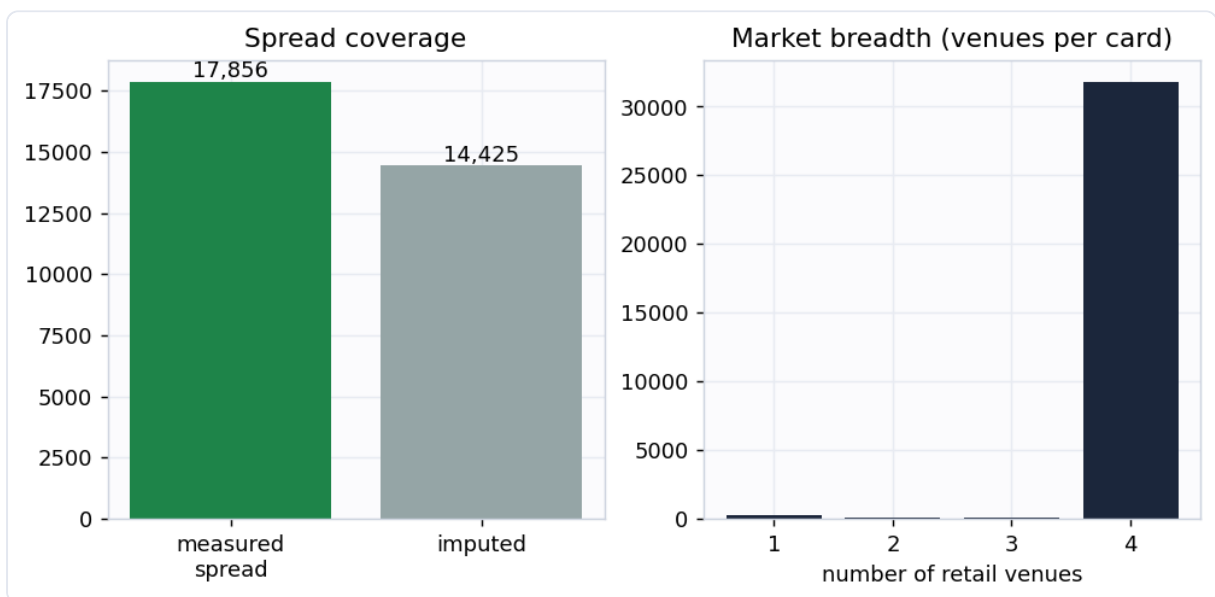
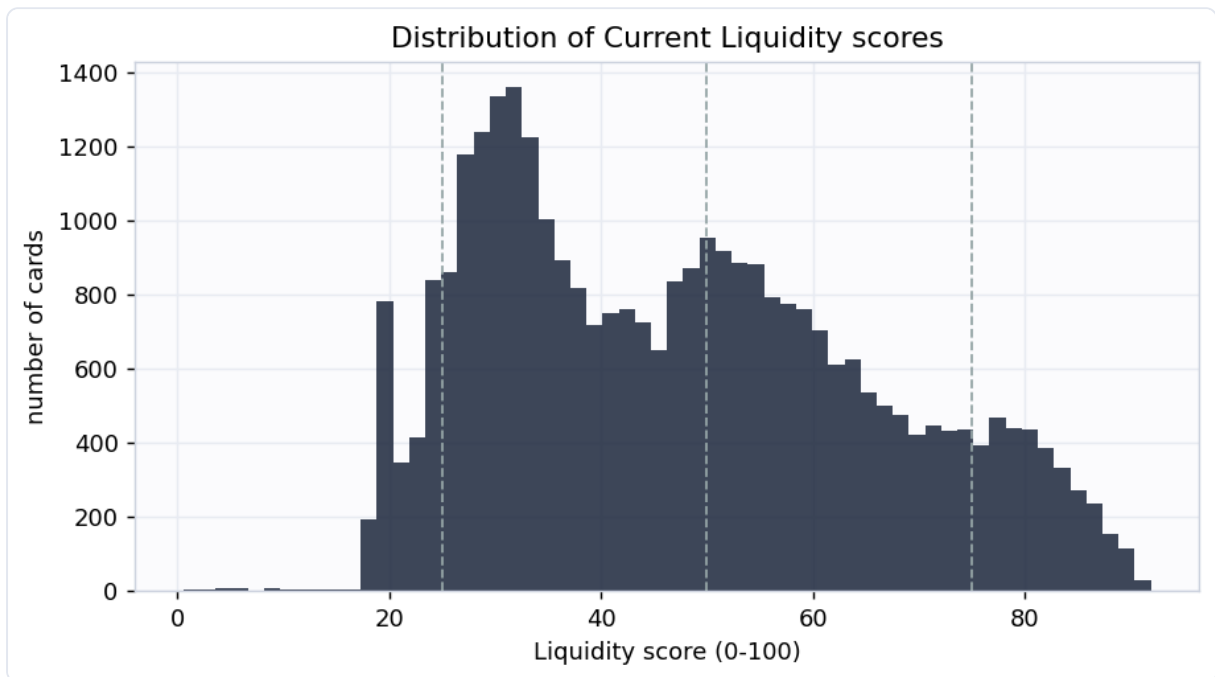
Liquidity is built from four measurable proxies, each normalized to a percentile and blended (weights {'spread': 0.4, 'depth': 0.25, 'activity': 0.2, 'demand': 0.15}):

| Component | What it measures                                                                                | Source                 |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Spread    | bid-ask cost to round-trip, CardKingdom buylist vs retail on the same printing                  | multi-venue price feed |
| Depth     | how many venues list the card, whether a dealer will buy it, cross-venue price agreement        | multi-venue price feed |
| Activity  | how often the quoted price actually moves over 120 days (a flat price means nothing is trading) | 16-year daily history  |
| Demand    | Commander-format popularity (EDHREC)                                                            | EDHREC                 |

A card scores high only when it is cheap to exit, sold in many places, actively repricing, and wanted. The weights lean on the spread because that is the cost an owner actually pays to sell.

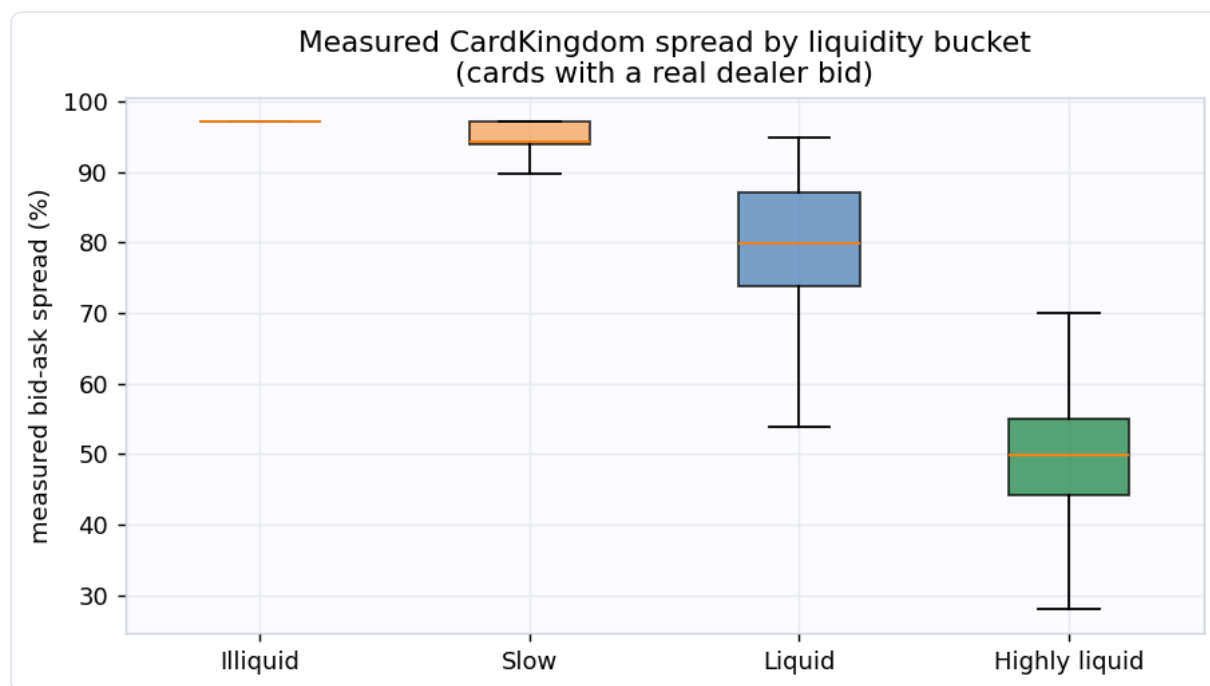
## Coverage

Scored **32,281 cards** at this snapshot. **17,856** of them have a real dealer bid (CardKingdom buylist), so their spread is **measured**, not estimated; the median measured spread is **87.2%**. Cards without a dealer bid are flagged `is_imputed` and scored from depth, activity, and demand only.



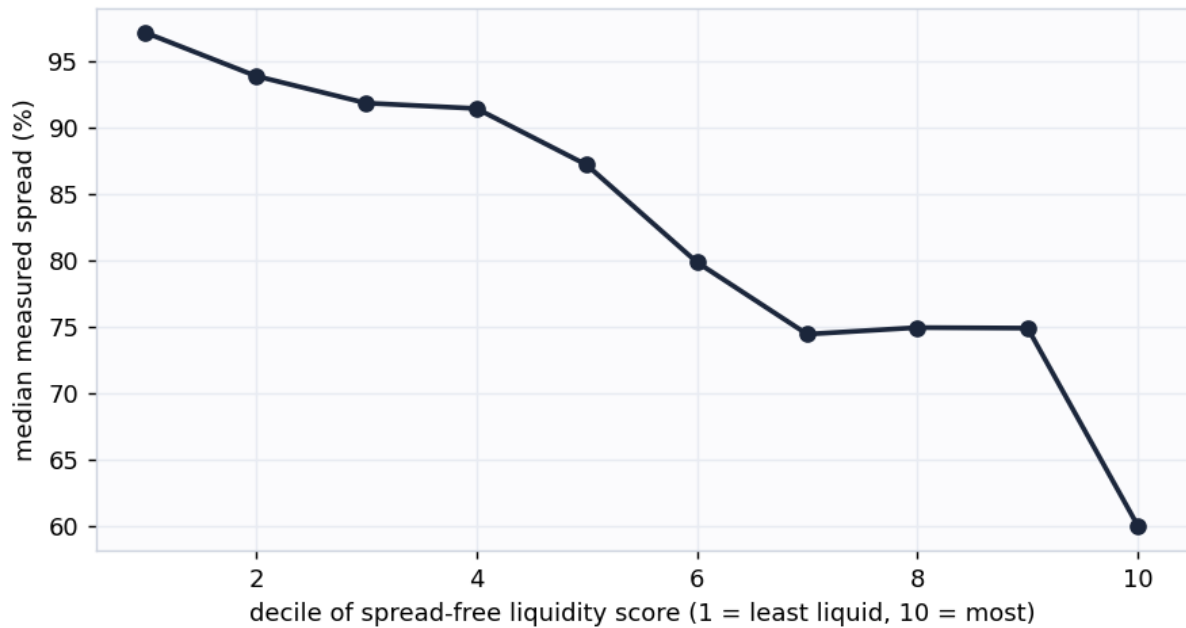
# Does the score mean anything? Two honest checks

**1. Measured spread lines up with the buckets.** Cards the index calls illiquid really do cost more to round-trip. Because the spread is one input to the score, this is partly a consistency check rather than a clean test.



**2. Independent proxies predict the spread (the real test).** If we rank cards using *only* depth, activity, and demand and deliberately **exclude the spread**, the measured spread still falls steadily as that spread-free score rises (rank correlation **0.471**). The proxies that never saw the spread agree with the spread. That is genuine corroboration, not circular reasoning.

## Independent proxies predict the measured spread (spread excluded from this ranking)



## Example cards

### Example cards (snapshot 2026-07-30)

|                                | Beastmaster Ascension<br>score 92   spread 38%                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Toxic Deluge<br>score 92   spread 37%                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Counterspell<br>score 92   spread 40%                                                                                                                                                                           | Karn Liberated<br>score 92   spread 32%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Cavern of Souls<br>score 92   spread 40%                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Most liquid</b>             | <p>Enchantment</p> <p>Whenever a creature you control attacks, you may put a quest counter on Beastmaster Ascension. As long as Beastmaster Ascension has seven or more quest counters on it, creatures you control get +5/+5.</p>                          | <p>Sorcery</p> <p>As an additional cost to cast this spell, pay X life. All creatures get -X/-X until end of turn. "Zemo insults me by talking me with workings such as you. Even together, you pose no challenge." —Radioactive Man, Dr. Chen Lu</p> | <p>Instant</p> <p>Counter target spell.</p>                                                                                                                                                                     | <p>Legendary Planeswalker — Karn</p> <p>24: Target player exiles a card from their hand. 31: Exile target permanent. Restart the game, leaving in exile all non-Quest permanent cards exiled with Karn Liberated. Then put these cards onto the battlefield under your control.</p>                                                                             | <p>Land</p> <p>As Cavern of Souls enters the battlefield, choose a creature type. • Add 9. • Add one mana of any color. Spend this mana only to cast a creature spell of the chosen type, and that spell can't be countered.</p> |
| <b>Least liquid (&gt; \$5)</b> | <p>Planeswalker — Bolas</p> <p>Each opponent loses 3 life unless that player sacrifices a nontoken permanent or discards a card. Destroy target creature. Draw a card. Nicol Bolas, the Deceiver deals 7 damage to each opponent. You draw seven cards.</p> | <p>Creature — Tiger</p> <p>Forestwalk. (If defending player has a forest in play, Zodiac Tiger can't be blocked.) "... Three kings no more — Chandra, Gintama, Ashi. The left and right must now be filled again. ..."</p>                            | <p>Artifact Creature — Cyberman</p> <p>Artifact creatures you control have afflict 3. (Whenever a creature with afflict 3 becomes blocked, defending player loses 3 life.) "Obey or you will be destroyed."</p> | <p>Legendary Artifact — Equipment</p> <p>Equipped creature has first strike and gets +1/+1 for each instant and sorcery card in your graveyard. Whenever equipped creature deals combat damage to a player, you may cast an instant or sorcery spell from your hand with mana value less than or equal to that damage without paying its mana cost. Equip 3</p> | <p>Legendary Creature — Human Soldier Warrior</p> <p>Horsemanship, haste "Dong Zhao's man, Lu Bu, warrior without peer, far surpassed the champions of his generation."</p>                                                      |

The most liquid cards are heavily played eternal and Commander staples that sell in minutes at a known price. The least liquid expensive cards are thin-market oddities: no dealer will quote a buy price, and they list in only one or two places.

## Buckets

| Bucket        | Score  | Cards  | Median measured spread |
|---------------|--------|--------|------------------------|
| Highly liquid | 75-100 | 3,313  | 49.9%                  |
| Liquid        | 50-75  | 10,659 | 79.9%                  |
| Slow          | 25-50  | 15,648 | 94.3%                  |
| Illiquid      | 0-25   | 2,661  | 97.1%                  |

## How this plugs into the other signals

Liquidity is a multiplier on every other call. It converts "should I sell" into "can I sell, how fast, at what cost," and it filters out illiquid buy candidates the spike model would otherwise flag. In the toolkit's risk-adjusted value equation, the expected value of a position is discounted by its spread and expected time-to-sale to get a **net realizable** value.

## Honest limitations

- This is **version 1: a composite proxy index, not a supervised forecast**. It does not carry a held-out AUC because there is no public ground-truth label for "days to sale."
- There is **no true traded-volume or listing-count data yet**. Spread, price staleness, and venue breadth are stand-ins for depth and velocity. The roadmap adds TCGplayer listing counts and sales velocity (the printing table already carries the join key), which will replace the proxies with measured depth.
- Buylist coverage is CardKingdom-only and United States centric. Cards without a CardKingdom bid have an imputed spread and should be read with that caveat.
- Informational only, not financial advice.

Generated by `scripts/build_report.py` from `data/processed/liquidity_features.parquet`.